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Galle Fort & South Coast Escape

APPROVED ITINERARY

Galle & South Coast, Sri Lanka | 10-16 December 2026 | 3 adults | Culture, Beaches, Heritage, Food
A relaxed 7-day coastal and cultural journey starting from Colombo, exploring the historic charm of Galle Fort and the budget-friendly beach vibes of the South Coast for 3 travelers.

7-Day Itinerary

Day 1 - Arrival & Transfer to Galle Fort

09:00 AM - Depart Colombo: Take a private taxi or scenic train ride down the Southern Expressway to Galle (approx. 2 hours by car).
12:00 PM - Check-in near the Beach: Settle into your budget-friendly beach accommodation near Galle.
03:30 PM - Stroll the Ramparts at Sunset: Walk along the historic UNESCO-listed Galle Fort ramparts and watch the sun dip into the Indian Ocean.
07:00 PM - Welcome Dinner: Enjoy authentic Sri Lankan rice and curry at a cozy local cafe inside the fort.

Day 2 - Exploring Galle Fort Heritage

09:00 AM - Historic Walking Tour: Explore the cobblestone streets, colonial Dutch architecture, boutiques, and the iconic Galle Lighthouse.
12:30 PM - Caf Lunch: Grab lunch and iced coffee at one of the artistic courtyard cafes tucked inside the fort.
03:00 PM - Maritime Museum Visit: Discover the naval history and maritime artifacts housed in a restored 17th-century Dutch warehouse.
06:00 PM - Fort Sunset & Gelato: Enjoy artisanal gelato while watching locals play cricket on the fort bastions.

Day 3 - Unawatuna Beach & Coastal Relaxation

09:30 AM - Head to Unawatuna Beach: Take a short tuk-tuk ride to Unawatuna for a day of sun, sand, and gentle waves.
11:00 AM - Japanese Peace Pagoda Hike: Take a short walk up to the pagoda for panoramic views over the southern coastline.
01:00 PM - Beachfront Seafood Lunch: Savor fresh catch-of-the-day seafood at a casual beach shack.
04:00 PM - Snorkeling or Swimming: Swim in the protected turquoise bay or rent snorkeling gear near Jungle Beach.

Day 4 - Surf & Chill in Weligama

09:00 AM - Travel to Weligama: Head further down the coast to Weligama, famous for its gentle waves and surf culture.

10:30 AM - Beginner Surf Lesson: Try out surfing in the shallow, sandy-bottom bay with local instructors.
01:00 PM - Kottu Roti Lunch: Stop at a local eatery to try Sri Lanka's famous street food dish, Kottu Roti.
03:30 PM - Coconut Tree Hill, Mirissa: Take a quick tuk-tuk to Mirissa to photograph the iconic Instagram-famous viewpoint at sunset.

Day 5 - Wildlife & Nature Day

08:30 AM - Koggala Lake Boat Safari: Take a peaceful morning boat ride through mangroves, visiting cinnamon island and local temples.
11:30 AM - Turtle Hatchery Visit: Learn about marine conservation efforts and view baby sea turtles at a local hatchery project.
01:30 PM - Local Rice & Curry: Enjoy a traditional home-cooked vegetarian rice and curry lunch near Ahangama.
04:00 PM - Sunset Beach Walk: Unwind with a quiet evening walk along the golden shores of the south coast.

Day 6 - Ahangama Stilt Fishermen & Craft Culture

09:00 AM - Stilt Fishermen Observation: Witness the traditional southern art of stilt fishing along the shallow waters.
11:00 AM - Handloom Weaving & Pottery: Visit local community workshops to see traditional Sri Lankan handicrafts being made.
01:00 PM - Trendy Coastal Lunch: Dine at one of the stylish design-forward cafes opening up along the Ahangama surf strip.
04:30 PM - Farewell Beach Bonfire: Relax at your accommodation's beach area with friends and family to celebrate the final evening.

Day 7 - Return to Colombo

09:00 AM - Morning Souvenir Shopping: Pick up tea, spices, and local crafts around Galle Fort before checking out.
11:30 AM - Check-out & Journey Back: Board your private vehicle or train for the return trip north to Colombo.
02:30 PM - Arrival in Colombo: Conclude your 7-day south coast adventure upon returning to Colombo.

Estimated budget

Currency: LKR (destination local currency) - estimates only, nothing is booked.
Flights: LKR 0
Hotel: LKR 63,000
Food & Drinks: LKR 42,000
Local Transport: LKR 22,500
Activities & Tours: LKR 30,000
Per person: LKR 52,500 (x 3 travellers)
Trip total: LKR 157,500
Adjusted for 7 days and 3 travelers starting from Colombo, utilizing budget-friendly beach accommodation and local transport.

Weather

Typical/current temperature: 28 deg C - Warm and tropical with occasional coastal breezes - Humidity: Moderate to high
Typical seasonal climate for December on the South Coast of Sri Lanka.

Accommodation

Wijenayake's Beach Haven Guest House (or similar budget beach stay) / Galle / South Coast
Budget-friendly accommodation offering local warmth and proximity to the coast.

Flights & transfers

Outbound: Domestic land travel from Colombo to Galle (approx. 2 hours)
Return: Return land travel from Galle to Colombo
No international flights needed as origin is Colombo.

Good to know

- Book a private hire car or use the coastal railway for a scenic and affordable journey from Colombo.
- Carry local currency (LKR) for tuk-tuks, small eateries, and market stalls.
- Respect local customs when visiting religious sites by dressing modestly (covering shoulders and knees).